



THE WAKING OF A NATION (2025)



"The idea that you cannot actually rule yourself... how did we believe that and let it happen? We got brainwashed"

RAM MADHVANI, *Filmmaker*

are acquainting viewers with events that deserve in-depth examination and the unsung heroes who merit recognition.

For Saugata Mukherjee, head of content at SonyLIV, the platform behind *Rocket Boys*, *Freedom at Midnight* and *The Waking of a Nation*, the ambitious dramas are completely aligned with their goal to "tell the big stories of India" and fill the gaping void in the Indian



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SAUGATA MUKHERJEE
Head of Content, SonyLIV

narrative landscape. "I don't think we have mined and celebrated our history enough," he says. "We have a treasure trove of forgotten stories. It's important for makers, writers, studios and platforms to find them. But they need to tell them in a fashion that is contemporary, entertaining, and doesn't become so niche that people stop watching history."

Historicals are by no means easy to make or view. Ask Advani, who is in the midst of directing hundreds of extras in *Revolutionaries* and overseeing edits of *Freedom at Midnight*, season two. Research is